

Speed matters

WiMAX 2 standard, and its theoretical 1Gbps downloads to be finalized in November. Hardware to be ratified through 2011 and might be commercially available in 2012

Nanotech teabag

A new "tea bag" uses nano-fibers to suck contaminants and bacteria out of water, providing a desperately-needed, cheap solution for the billions of people without clean drinking water

Moving to Linux

I have one query for Linux OS. I have an Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 processor and 2 GB of RAM. Currently, I am using Windows XP on my system, and I want to install the Linux OS on my system. Can you help me out from this problem that which Linux OS will be suitable for my system, and how do I get it?

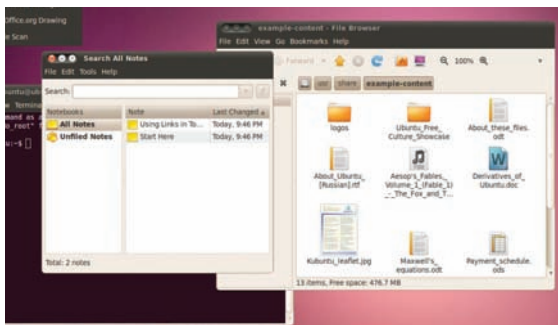
Krutarth Purohit

Ubuntu (www.ubuntu.com) is considered the best for newcomers to Linux. It's freely available for download and you can also find it on our previous DVDs. Burn the image on the DVD and boot using the DVD drive.

Display goes blank every now and then

I am a Digit subscriber from the past year. I needed help regarding my display.

When the OS (Windows 7) loads, my screen goes blank. On displaying of the



Ubuntu Linux is one of the simplest Linux distributions to get started with

welcome screen, it retains the display. But when I launch any game, it goes blank again. I always need to manually unplug the signal cord and attach it back when this happens from the monitor at runtime. I need to do it when the PC is on. Upon reboot, the same problem occurs. This never used to happen before, since the past week I got a Seagate 1TB drive (internal). I have the latest drivers updated for ATI v10.7. Could you please advise. My configuration is as follows:

- Microsoft Windows 7 Ultimate x86
- Intel Core 2 Duo E8400 3.0 GHz
- Abit IP35-E Mobo
- Corsair XMS2 DDR2 2 GB RAM
- Palit HD4850 512MB DDR3 Graphic card

- 1 TB Seagate 7200.12 internal
- 500GB Seagate 5400.12 internal
- Corsair TX650 Power Supply
- Viewsonic VA1928wm Monitor

Nereus Hixon

It's an odd problem for sure. If the monitor has an auto-detect mode which allows you to switch from DVI and VGA, set it to use the DVI by default. In the display properties and through the drivers, make sure you set the monitor as the default display.

Can't make changes to disk drive

I bought a Sony VGN-BZ15GN VAIO laptop last year. The configuration of the system is Intel Core 2 Duo P8400 (2.26 GHz), Hard Disk: 200 GB, Memory: 2 GB, Windows Vista Business / Windows XP SP2.

Since Vista is too slow, I installed Windows XP. Then, I tried to install drivers and applications that I downloaded, but they weren't working. So, I switched to Windows 7 where I deleted everything while installing and formatting. Now, I tried to revert to Vista because some applications such as Fingerprint, Cam, Card Reader, Bluetooth, and Battery management were not working. But, I can't. I made a recovery CD that doesn't work either. As of now, I can't install any OS on my laptop. I get an error "can't write disk". So, I took out the hard disk from my

laptop, made an external hard disk and tried to format it, but it can't create any more partitions. While using software such as EASEUS Partition Master, I can create and format. But still can't install any OS. Please help.

Hazel Khashim

It was a bad idea to reinstall operating systems like that on your laptop. Sony laptops have a partition where the backup and recovery data for the shipped OS is stored. During the installs, you might have deleted those partitions and there's no way to restore the OS back the right way. If Sony has provided you with a recovery disc of some sort, use it to

restore Windows back to its initial state. If all fails, inquire with the Sony customer care to see if they can fix things for you. Opening the laptop and removing the hard drive might have void warranty too.

Poor gamer laptop

I own a Dell Inspiron laptop with the following configuration: Intel Core2 i3 350M (2.67 GHz), 3 GB RAM, ATI Mobility Radeon HD 5470 (512MB), Windows 7 64-bit. I've installed some of the hottest titles in PC games such as *Splinter Cell: Conviction* and *Prototype*. When I start the game, it appears like the system has slowed down a lot. I'm unable to get smooth frame rates.

Cibi Vishnu

The Radeon 5470 is not a high-end graphics solution and isn't designed to run games such as *Splinter Cell: Conviction* and *Prototype*. Lower the quality settings and hopefully, the games will run smoother.

Memory upgrade for Maya 2010?

Kindly suggest a configuration to get the best out of Autodesk Maya 2010 (January 2010) in my PC. How much RAM should I increase to if my PC configuration is Intel Pentium Dual Core with 2.89 GHz and RAM is 256 MB.

Vinod Kumar

You should upgrade to 2 GB of RAM at least for decent performance. The processor also needs to be powerful when you start working on more advanced and intensive scenes and models.

Powering modem through USB

I have an ADSL2 Modem that I use for internet access. I had a power adapter for power. But a few days back, the adapter got burnt. A friend of mine advised me to power it from the USB connection on my PC. I do not know the cable connections and I also want to know if that cable is available in market. The modem is connected with LAN Port of PC. Is it advisable to power it from PC.

Rajesh Kumar